

- The **Atherian Empire** is founded in the region that is now the **Thalmyric Empire**. The Atherians, originating from advanced city-states around the Thalassian Sea, gradually unite their people under one banner via conquest.
- Under the guidance of the divine emperor, the Atherians expand northwards into the steppes bordering the desert, and southwards into the volcanic mountains, conquering and assimilating nearby territories. The **Star Pantheon** is formalized, with celestial worship becoming deeply intertwined with the Atherian belief system.
- The Atherian Empire reaches its peak, expanding across much of the known world. Their armies push eastward, conquering the lands that will later become **Eclessia**. These regions are primarily rural and undeveloped, home to various tribal cultures (like the **Enaidfae**) as well as Jirahar Tower-Towns that dot the eastern most coastline going into the mountains. Colonization begins, with Atherian culture, religion, and infrastructure spreading into these new lands.
- The **Sestaran Peninsula** is integrated into the empire after a series of successful naval campaigns. The **Atherian Empire** builds vast infrastructure, including aqueducts, roads, and public buildings, creating a sophisticated and connected empire.
- **Isfir the Redeemer** is born among the Jirahar in a whilst on the road during a seasonal caravan within the eastern region of the Atherian Empire (later to become **Eclessia**).
- His teachings focus on **divine love, self-sacrifice**, and rejecting the old gods (the **Star Pantheon**) as well as the strict and fundamental laws of his own people the Jirharian. His message quickly gains traction among the lower classes and rural populations in the east, who feel neglected by the empire.
- Performs miracles, casts out demons, gathers a band of followers.
- The Redeemer's teachings begin to spread throughout the Atherian provinces, moving from the east and going into the west. He performs miracles, casts out demons and gathers followers, challenging the established religious order. The Atherian authorities view him as a threat, and tension grows between the Redeemer's followers and the imperial government.
- The Redeemer is brought to the capital of the Atherian Empire Caleran (modern-day **Thalmyria**), where he is executed by a coalition of Atherian officials and Jirahar priests. Three days later, he miraculously returns from the dead, solidifying the faith of his followers and spreading the belief that he is the **incarnation of the Lord** with his ascension leaving behind the **Holy Flame** in his stead for his followers.
- A long period of imperial persecution. Countless saints and martyrs.
- The **Faith of the Redeemer** spreads rapidly through the eastern parts of the Atherian Empire (which already had grassroots from his ministry starting there), especially among rural populations. The western provinces, still culturally Atherian but more disconnected from the imperial heartland, begin to shift away from the Star Pantheon. The **Sanctum Divinitatis** is established in the western Kingdom of **Aurelia** to oversee the faith's growth.
- After much resistance, persecution, and conflict, the entire **Atherian Empire** gradually converts to the faith of the Redeemer. The Atherian emperors, seeking stability, eventually accept the Redeemer's teachings, outlawing the worship of the Star Pantheon and replacing it with the new faith. The **Redeemer's Faith** becomes the state religion, and the empire attempts to integrate the new doctrine into its governance.

- Pogroms against the Jirahar escalate; their Tower Towns are razed.
- Survivors flee through the Sestarn Peninsula northwest into the steppes and deserts of what will become **Ahl-e-Ahd** territory.
- Empire turns inward. No expansion, little pressure.
- A succession of weak emperors.
- Barbarian raids from the **southern Enaidfae**.
- Coastal raids from the **Ättar**.
- The Concord City-States in Sestara grow richer and more independent.
- Rumors of a unifying prophet among the desert tribes begin to spread.
- The **Ahl-e-Ahd** empire rises in the northwest, a powerful and militaristic force guided by their own faith centered around **contract-binding magic**. Their empire expands aggressively, pushing toward the northwestern borders of the **Atherian Empire**.
- **In the lead-up to the jihad**, the Ahl-e-Ahd Caliphate sends a **formal delegation to the Atherian court**, presenting a scroll of surrender terms. The document—**legally airtight, yet impossibly demanding**—requires the emperor to **dissolve the Redeemer Church, submit to Caliphal arbitration**, and **sign over sovereignty of all western provinces** to be "governed under divine contract."
- The Atherian court, bloated with privilege and untouched by real war for generations, **laughs the delegation out of the chamber**. Ministers and courtiers, more concerned with ceremony than consequence, **fail to recognize the legal trap** set for them.
- **The rejection is precisely what the Ahl-e-Ahd sought**. With terms offered and refused, the Caliphate declares the **Contract Breach Clause activated**, granting them the **theological and legal mandate to commence the jihad**. The invasion begins shortly after, with the Ahl-e-Ahd claiming not war, but **righteous enforcement of covenant**.
- The Ahl-e-Ahd a sudden, overwhelming **jihad** into the western territories of the **Atherian Empire**.
- The invasion is swift and brutal with massive losses; empire being unprepared for the Ahl-e-Ahd's siege golems, bound devils and demon shock troops, and Janissaries with several norther provinces, falling to Ahl-e-Ahd control. The **Emirate of Zanthir** is established in the far north of what used to be the Atherian Empire and establishes the **Velian States** as puppet regions across occupied southern provinces.
- In response to the Ahl-e-Ahd invasion, the Atherian emperor calls for the first Crusade (Defensive) - which initially slows the advance and redirects vast resources, manpower, and military forces from the east to defend the western heartlands. This creates a power vacuum in the eastern provinces (modern **Eclessia** and the Sestaran Concord City States), which are now under-resourced and under-defended.
- As the Atherian Empire struggles to defend itself in the west, the eastern provinces begin to experience widespread instability. **Banditry, Enaidfae** incursions from the south, and internal rebellion break out, leading to the collapse of imperial control in the east. Local governments in these regions start to break away from the central empire, attempting to defend themselves without the help of the imperial legions.

- A fragile peace is negotiated between the Atherian Empire in the west and the Ahl-e-Ahd in the northwest, whilst each side ramps up for the next war.
- The Atherian Empire begins to fracture. In the west, the empire is locked in a desperate struggle to prepare for a new war against the **Ahl-e-Ahd**, while in the east, local rulers start to declare autonomy from the empire. The eastern provinces fall into an **interregnum**, with various factions vying for control over the once-great empire's territories.
- Second Crusade is called to retake the Velian States—a **disaster**.
- Ahl-e-Ahd seize the moment, marching all the way to **Caleran**, capital of Atheria in the west.
- Caleran falls, occupied and desecrated, the emperor and his family executed in the city square and churches, iconography and anything related to the Redeemer is burnt and destroyed. Atherian royals who couldn't escape are mass slaughtered in the streets, forever staining the main roads rust coloured from the blood.
- Refugees flee to the **volcanic mountains** and their passes in the south (modern Thalmyria).
- The city-states of the **Sestaran Peninsula** declare independence, forming the **Concord of Sestara**, a confederation of free cities. While they retain some aspects of Atherian culture, they emphasize their independence from both the Thalmyric Empire and Eclessia. These city-states become key hubs of trade, philosophy, and maritime power.
- Atherian rebel general from a minor house leads a **guerrilla defense** in the southern mountains.
- A smaller Third Crusade (mostly by the centrally positioned Dutchy of Caldria and its supporting neighbours, including controversial help from warlocks from the nearby Citadel of Vorthara) is called to stop the attempted Ahl-e-Ahd main force from entering into Eclessia, which successfully stops it at the **Duchy of Caldria**
- Legendary **Valley Ambush** cripples Ahl-e-Ahd elite forces on their way back from the defeat at Caldria in an attempted to secure the southern part of the realm from the Atherian rebels and refugees hiding in the mountain passes.
- Further Victory at **Virelos** in the west cements the rebels' success and a growing turn of the tides, as the Ahl-e-Ahd forces are now seemingly spread far to thin and have lost 4 of the 5 great golem siege engines since the war started.
- Rebel commander crowned as the **First Thalmyric Emperor**, officially rebranding themselves as **Thalmyria**, claiming continuity from the Atherian Empire.
- The Thalmyric Redeemer Church-sanctions a fourth crusade (the Reconquest) led by Thalmyria, now with **weaponized Holy Flame**.
- Siege of **Caleran** is won—city retaken, invaders and collaborators executed.
- Other rebel cells across the continent rise up, some succeeding, others crushed.
- Though smaller and focused primarily around the **Thalassian Sea**, the Thalmyric Empire retains much of the **Atherian** culture, infrastructure, and technology. They begin their long-standing effort to **reconquer** their northern territories lost to the Ahl-e-Ahd, framing it as both a religious and political mission.
- Eclessia fights its own battles in the east but remains fractured.

- The eastern regions of the former Atherian Empire, now fractured and isolated, fall under the spiritual leadership of the **Sanctum Divinitatis** in **Aurelia**. The region, now known as **Eclessia**, begins its long struggle to rebuild after the collapse, with local rulers and kingdoms competing for dominance. The church declares that **whoever reunites Eclessia will be divinely mandated** as the true successor of the Atherian Empire.
- The Thalmyric Empire solidifies its hold over the western part of the former Atherian heartlands, but the ongoing war with the Ahl-e-Ahd and attempts at **reconquest** slow their progress. The Ahl-e-Ahd control key northern territories, creating a permanent state of war between the two powers.
- Borders between **Eclessia**, **Thalmyria**, **Sestara**, and **Ahl-e-Ahd** stabilize.
- The political and cultural landscape is now firmly divided between the **Thalmyria**, **Eclessia**, and the **Concord of Sestara**, with the **Ahl-e-Ahd** empire controlling parts of the northern regions. Religious tensions between the newly formed **Eclessian Church** and **Thalmyric Church** deepen, with both claiming to be the true successor to the Redeemer's legacy.
- **Eclessia**: Religious, fragmented, yearning for unity.
 - Various kingdoms and territories within **Eclessia** remain locked in a state of **interregnum**, with no single ruler able to unite the region. The **Sanctum Divinitatis** continues to assert its authority, but political fragmentation persists. **Eclessia** sees sporadic internal conflicts as rival rulers attempt to consolidate power.
- **Thalmyria**: Militarized, mystical, proud heirs of the Atherian legacy.
 - The **Thalmyric Empire** pushes deeper into the northern territories, attempting to reclaim lands lost to the **Ahl-e-Ahd** centuries ago.
- **Sestara**: Rich and independent, mercantile and artistic, a renaissance zone.
 - The **Concord of Sestara** remains independent, wary of both empires but keen on maintaining its autonomy through trade and diplomacy.
- **Ahl-e-Ahd**: Still powerful, but cracks are forming from within.
- **Fäskogarfolk** remain wild and mostly unconquered, yet deeply entangled.
- **(Present Day)**